

Leon Bowie

Platform Engineering Leader · Engineering Manager · Cyber Security

leon@darkflame.dev | darkflame.dev | github/Darkflame72 | homelab | linkedin/leon-bowie

SUMMARY

Platform engineering leader with a track record of building internal developer platforms and engineering functions from the ground up. Founded and scaled FNZ's platform engineering function, defined platform strategy, and drove organisation-wide adoption of self-service developer tooling across multiple regions and acquisitions. Skilled at treating platforms as products, translating engineering investment into measurable developer experience outcomes, and leading high-performing teams through periods of rapid growth.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Lead DevOps Engineer

2021 – Present

FNZ · Wellington, New Zealand

- Founded FNZ's global DevOps Engineering team, building the function from zero and establishing the practices and operating model used globally.
- Transitioned the team into a product-centric platform engineering model, expanding scope from DevOps delivery to own all internal developer tooling serving 2,000 developers.
- Manages the full internal tooling estate – developer portal, self-service CI/CD, source control standards, and all internal developer tooling – treating each as a platform product with defined ownership, roadmap, and adoption metrics.
- Led platform integration for 15 acquisitions, defining the onboarding playbook that brought acquired engineering teams onto the internal platform with minimal friction.

Contractor

2026 – Present

Te Matatini · Wellington, New Zealand

- Designed and built a complete scoring platform for Aotearoa's national kapa haka festival, used across multiple regional competitions and the national event.
- Delivered the system end-to-end, architecture, implementation, and deployment.

Founder and CEO

2022 – 2026

Tūhura Tech · Wellington, New Zealand

- Established and ran a charitable organisation focused on youth technology education.
- Secured funding and sponsorships from government and corporate partners to expand reach, including recognition in the Regional Economic Development Plan.
- Designed and delivered courses spanning game development, robotics, and cyber security to youth aged 9–18.
- Recognised with multiple awards, including Supreme Charity and Education and Youth Development awards.

Research Assistant

Oct. 2021 – Nov. 2022

Te Herenga Waka – Victoria University of Wellington · Wellington, New Zealand

- Designed infrastructure combining cloud SaaS services and custom applications to collect and store IoT sensor data in distributed systems.
- Contributed to hardware prototyping, research reports, and academic publications.

AWARDS

- ◆ **3rd Place (Team Oceania)** International Cyber Security Challenge 2026
- ◆ **Winner – Supreme Charity (Tūhura Tech)** Hutt City Community Awards 2025
- ◆ **Winner – Education and Youth Development (Tūhura Tech)** Hutt City Community Awards 2025
- ◆ **3rd Place (Australia Guest Team)** European Cyber Security Competition 2024 and 2025
- ◆ **1st Place, Grand Champions** NZ Cyber Security Competition 2022
- ◆ **3rd Place Tertiary, 5th Overall** NZ Cyber Security Competition 2021
- ◆ **Wild at Heart Community Spirit Award** Wellington Airport Community Awards 2020

EDUCATION

BSc in Computer Science

2021 – 2023

Te Herenga Waka – Victoria University of Wellington · Wellington, New Zealand

- Specialisation in Cyber Security and Machine Learning / Artificial Intelligence

Introduction to Platform Engineering

2025

Platform Engineering University · Online

Montessori 12–18 Orientation

2024

Association Montessori International · Online

COMMUNITY & VOLUNTEERING HIGHLIGHTS

◆ Adviser — UK Cyber Team	2026
Women's International Cybersecurity Competition & European Cyber Security Competition	
◆ Director — Team Oceania	2025 – 2026
International Cyber Security Challenge (3rd place, 2026)	
◆ Head Coach — Team Australia	2025
European Cyber Security Competition	
◆ NZ & Education Coordinator · Vice President of the Board	2025
DownUnderCTF	
◆ Wellington Regional Coordinator	2022 – 2026
KiwiBots	
◆ President of the Victoria Engineering Club	2021 – 2022
Te Herenga Waka — Victoria University of Wellington	
◆ Founded Aspiring Computer Science Trust	2017
◆ Code Club Volunteer	2016 – 2021
Code Club Aotearoa	